THE HELPER BEES · RESOURCE LIBRARY

Aetna Case Manager FAQ

Answers to common Benefits Hub, referral, and ticket-writing questions

1 Getting help

Submit a request through the Aetna Zendesk Support Form. In Benefits Hub, select the **person icon** in the top right, then **Submit a ticket**. When completing the form:

- Select **Case Manager** as the person submitting the request.
- Choose the issue type that best matches your request.
- Use a specific subject that identifies the member and request.
- Include the member and referral information listed below.
- Attach screenshots or supporting documentation when relevant.
- Every field except Attachments is required. If a member-specific field does not apply, enter **N/A**.

Include as much of the following as possible:

- Your first and last name, title, organization, email address, and phone number
- Member first and last name, date of birth, and Member ID
- Member address, including city, state, and ZIP code
- Referral number, if one exists, and the benefit (Recovery at Home, Post-Discharge, Personal Care, or Companion Care)
- Discharge date, if applicable
- Current referral status and assigned provider, if known
- A clear description of the issue and the action or resolution you are requesting
- Relevant dates, attempted actions, error messages, screenshots, or other supporting information

Providing complete information helps The Helper Bees review the request without needing to ask for basic details first.

2 Choosing the issue type

Use the issue type that most closely matches the request:

Issue type	Use it for
I need help logging in	Portal access, password, or account invitation issues.
I have a question about my order/service/referral	Referral status, service timing, or general referral questions.
Account creation/deletion	New or removed Case Manager access.
Provider: change request/report a provider issue	Provider assignment, reassignment, decline, outreach, or provider concern.
Report system issue/outage	Portal errors, missing records, or system behavior that prevents work.
Need a refund	Only when the request is specifically related to a refund question.

Subject line examples

- Post-Discharge referral 12345 — provider reassignment request
- Member ID 123456789012 — unable to create referral
- Referral 12345 — request for expiration review
- Benefits Hub access — password reset email not received

3 Frequently asked questions

Benefits Hub access

What should I do if I cannot log in to Benefits Hub?

Use the Benefits Hub login URL (https://aetnabenefits.thehelperbees.com). Enter your email address and select Forgot password if you need to reset your password. If you still cannot log in, submit an Aetna Zendesk ticket (Issue Type: I need help logging in) with the email address on your account, what happens when you try to log in, the exact error message, a screenshot if available, and the date and approximate time of the failed attempt.

What if I never received my account invitation or password-reset email?

Submit an Aetna Zendesk request and confirm the email address that should be associated with your Benefits Hub account. Check your spam or junk folder first, and include a screenshot or description of any message displayed in the portal.

What if my account is active but I still cannot create a referral?

Submit the request with the member ID, member name, benefit, the exact error message, and a screenshot. Do not omit the error message. Messages such as “There are no services available for the selected Client Program” help identify the issue.

Referral creation

Who creates an Aetna referral?

Aetna Case Managers create referrals for eligible members through Benefits Hub. The Helper Bees can review an existing referral, but cannot create a new Aetna referral on behalf of a Case Manager.

How many referrals can I create?

It depends on the benefit. **Personal Care:** one per member per year, per plan. **Companion Care:** one per member per calendar quarter. **Recovery at Home:** one per qualifying diagnosis, per member, per year. **Post-Discharge:** a new referral for each new discharge. A second Personal Care or Companion Care referral in the same period fails at checkout with an Eligibility fail message. Review the member's authorization in Benefits Hub before creating another referral.

What should I do if the member has another hospital discharge?

For Post-Discharge or Recovery at Home, select Add Referral. When the hours left are fewer than one referral's worth, Benefits Hub asks, “Does this member need a new post-discharge referral?” Answer **Yes, new discharge**. The hours go back to the full amount (12 for Post-Discharge), and leftover hours do not add on top. If the member was readmitted while a referral is still open, submitting the new referral closes the open one as Eligibility Failed, and its unused hours expire. You do not close it yourself.

What if care will happen somewhere other than the member's home?

On the Add Referral page, select (change service address) and enter where care will take place, **before you choose the service and add to cart**. Services refresh for the new location, and the address carries through to checkout. Only one alternative address is allowed per checkout, and the member's address on file does not change. The checkout screen only shows the address. If it is wrong, remove the item from the cart, go back, and change it on the Add Referral page.

Do I have to answer every question on the referral?

Required questions are marked with a red asterisk, and Add to Cart turns on when they are answered. Personal Care requires at least two ADLs. Companion Care requires all six facility questions and at least one SSBCI chronic condition. Optional questions can be left blank.

What should I do if the referral type or hours are incorrect?

Submit an Aetna Zendesk request instead of guessing or creating additional referrals. Include the existing referral number, member ID and name, correct benefit, correct authorized hours, discharge date (if applicable), what was entered incorrectly, and the correction needed.

What should I do if I cannot find the member or referral?

Confirm you searched using the correct 12-digit Aetna member number. If it still doesn't appear, submit a request with the member ID, name and date of birth, benefit, referral number (if known), discharge date (if applicable), the search steps completed, and a screenshot of the result or error.

Referral status and delayed services

What do the referral statuses mean?

New: created and awaiting approval. **Approved:** recognized, but not yet assigned to a local provider. **Assigned to Provider:** a provider was found and alerted, and has 3 days to respond. **Accepted By Provider:** the provider accepted, and contact information can be shared with the member. **Unable to Contact:** the provider couldn't reach the member after 3 attempts. **Member Declined Services:** the member declined the provider that reached out. **Completed:** all rate types have been invoiced and billed. **Closed:** the service was refunded and the referral is inactive. **On Hold:** Personal Care is paused while Recovery at Home is open. **Eligibility Failed:** the referral was closed, including when a readmission replaces it.

How can I check a referral's status?

Open the member's record in Benefits Hub and review the referral details, status, provider assignment, and referral notes. If you need clarification, include the referral number and current status in your Zendesk request.

What does it mean if the referral has not been assigned or accepted?

The referral may be waiting for provider assignment or acceptance. The member should not be told that services are scheduled until a provider has accepted the referral and confirmed scheduling. If it has remained unassigned or unaccepted, submit a request with the referral number, member information, current status, and the date the referral was created.

What should I do if the member has not been contacted?

Submit a request with the member's name and ID, referral number, referral creation date, assigned provider (if known), the member's best phone number and any alternate contact, the date outreach was expected, and whether the member has already tried to contact the provider. After you submit a referral, The Helper Bees may contact the member or their point person to confirm interest. Provider scheduling occurs after the provider accepts.

What if the provider declined the referral?

Submit a request if the member still needs services, including the referral number, provider name, reason for the decline if known, member's current address, and any time-sensitive circumstances.

What if no provider is available in the member's area?

Submit a request with the complete service address, referral number, requested service, and the date services are needed, and explain whether providers have already declined or whether none has been identified.

Managing a referral

Where can I find referral notes, and do notes alert The Helper Bees?

Notes are in the member's referral record: use **View > View Notes**. Review them for outreach attempts, provider communication, scheduling updates, and next steps before submitting a follow-up request. To add one, use **Add > Add Note** and choose a note type. **Adding a note does not alert The Helper Bees.** If something needs action, submit a Zendesk ticket.

Can I edit the referral narrative?

Yes. Case managers can write the narrative on Add Referral and edit it later with the pencil next to Referral Narrative, up to 250 characters. When the service has questions, Benefits Hub adds a first line telling providers to review them, and it counts toward the 250.

How do I record a discharge date?

On a **Recovery at Home** referral only: expand the referral, select **Add > Discharge date**, and enter the date the member was discharged to home. The box shows the new expiration before you save. It blocks a future date and a date that would make the referral already expired (contact THB), and it warns you if the expiration moves earlier. The option stays in the Add menu so the date can be corrected later.

When does a Recovery at Home referral expire?

Until a discharge date is recorded, 30 days after submission, never later than 12/31. After it is recorded, 30 days after the discharge date, with day one the day after discharge.

How do I add a document, or share a referral's status?

Use **Add > Add Document** for proof of POA or TPA, a discharge summary, or authorization paperwork. Documents are visible to the THB coordinator. To share status with a member or family, use **View > Copy Tracking Link**. They can open it without logging in.

Can I add or correct a member's email address?

Yes. In the member's Overview, select the pencil next to Email, type the address, and select the check mark.

Extensions and reassignment

How do I request an extension?

Submit an Aetna Zendesk request before the referral expires whenever possible. Include the referral number, member ID and name, discharge date, referral creation date, current expiration date, provider assignment/acceptance status, dates of provider outreach or attempted services, the reason services could not be completed, and the requested new expiration date if known. Extensions are reviewed case by case and are not automatic.

How do I request a provider reassignment?

Submit a request with the referral number, member's full service address, current provider, reason for reassignment, and any relevant member or provider communication, for example, the provider hasn't contacted the member, declined the referral, can't service the area, or is no longer available.

Can the member request a specific provider?

Include the requested provider's name, location, and contact information in the Zendesk request. Availability and network status must still be reviewed before the referral can be assigned.

Address and county corrections

What should I include when the member's service address changes?

Include the referral number, member ID, complete new address, and effective date. Service addresses cannot be edited directly in Benefits Hub once a referral is created, so any change requires a Zendesk ticket. To avoid that, confirm the service address on Add Referral before you check out.

What if the county is incorrect?

Submit the member's full address, referral number, current county, and correct county, and explain how the error is affecting provider assignment or service availability. The county can affect which providers are available, so accurate address information helps ensure the referral is reviewed for the correct service area.

Benefit and service questions

What services may be available through an Aetna referral?

Depending on the member's plan, Benefits Hub shows up to four benefits: Personal Care, Post-Discharge (Post-Discharge - No Conditions follows the same steps), Recovery at Home, and Companion Care. Available hours are determined by the plan and the authorization shown in Benefits Hub.

Are services medical services?

No. Personal Care and Companion Care are non-medical support services. Caregivers do not perform tasks that require nursing skills.

What do medication reminders include?

Medication reminders help a member remember to take medication at the prescribed time. They do not include administering medication, sorting medication, or filling a pill container for later use.

When can the member schedule services?

The member can coordinate scheduling directly with the provider after the service request has been created and accepted by a provider.

Grievances, safety, and service concerns

How do I report a serious provider or caregiver concern?

Submit an Aetna Zendesk request and clearly identify the concern in the subject line. Include the member's name and ID, referral number, provider name and phone number (if known), date and time of the incident, date of service (if applicable), a detailed description of what occurred, any reported injury, safety concern, or unmet need, and the action or response requested.

How do I report a concern about hours billed versus hours provided?

Include the referral number, provider, dates of service, hours billed, hours the member says were provided, and any supporting notes or documentation. Describe the discrepancy and whether the member wants an audit, correction, or clarification.

What if the member wants to file a grievance?

Submit the grievance details through the Aetna Zendesk form, including the grievance number, response due date, member's complaint, date of service, provider information, and the resolution or investigation requested.

4 Ticket writing template

Field	What to include
Subject	[Referral or Member ID] – [specific request] – [benefit]
Your info	[Your name, title, organization, email, and phone number]
Member	[Name, date of birth, Member ID, and address]
Referral	[Referral number, if one exists, and benefit]
Discharge date	[If applicable]
Current status	[What the portal shows, and assigned provider if known]
Issue description	[What's happening, including error messages if any]
Requested action	[The specific correction, follow-up, or escalation needed]
Supporting info	[Relevant dates, attempted actions, screenshots, or documents]

KEY TAKEAWAY

Keep the ticket number from your submission and reply to the existing ticket for any follow-up instead of submitting a duplicate request about the same issue.

What happens after I submit a request?

The Helper Bees reviews the request and may contact you through the email address provided. For additional assistance, call The Helper Bees at 888-433-4105. Hours are Monday through Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. local time, except Alaska and Hawaii, which follow 8:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. Pacific Time.